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MEDIEVAL INDIA

मध्यकालीन भारत — उच्च-प्राथमिकता पुनरावलोकन

Delhi Sultanate Chronology & Departments, Mughal Administrative Hierarchy, Maratha Administration, Bhakti & Sufi Movements, and Key Chroniclers & Battles.

- **High-Yield Ratta Matrix**
  Concentrated prelims facts, tables & comparisons
- **Examiner Trap Eliminators**
  Confused pairs and high-frequency exam traps
- **15–20 Min Daily Read**
  Formulated for active morning memory drills
- **Exam-Aligned Coverage**
  Curated strictly for UPPSC Prelims, RO/ARO & BEO

UP-PCS & UK-PCS Examination Resource
General Studies Paper 1 · Prelims Fast-Recall Desk

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Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts (Medieval India)

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

Exam Focus: UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), UKPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO
Frequency: Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
Question Types Covered: Diwan-i-X departments & Sultanate officers, Mughal administrative hierarchy (Mir Bakhshi, Mir Saman), Land classification (Polaj, Parauti), Revenue systems (Zabt/Dahsala, Batai), Mansabdari & Jagirdari (Zat/Sawar, Du-aspa), Vijayanagara Nayankara & Ayagar systems, Foreign travelers vs Kings, Battle chronological order, Medieval Monuments & Architectural Milestones, Medieval Literature & Authors, Bhakti & Sufi saints vs Philosophies, Shivaji's Ashtapradhan, Medieval Taxes (Jizya, Zakat, Khams, Kharaj).

1. Delhi Sultanate Chronology & Dynastic Founders

Dynasty	Period	Founder	Greatest / Key Ruler	Last Ruler	Capital
Slave / Mamluk / Ilbari	**1206–1290**	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (Lakhbaksh)	**Iltutmish** (real consolidator, introduced Silver Tanka & Copper Jital, Chalisa / Turkan-i-Chahalgani), **Balban** (Blood and Iron policy, Sijda & Paibos, Nauroz festival)	Kayumars (killed by Jalaluddin)	Lahore → Delhi (Iltutmish made Delhi capital)
Khalji	**1290–1320**	**Jalaluddin Khalji**	**Alauddin Khalji** (Market regulations / Shahna-i-Mandi, Dagh & Chehra, expanded to South India under Malik Kafur)	Khusrau Khan (usurper)	Delhi (Siri Fort)
Tughlaq (*Longest ruling: 94 yrs*)	**1320–1414**	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (Ghazi Malik; built Tughlaqabad)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Token currency, capital shift to Daulatabad, Qarachil & Khurasan expeditions), **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (Canals, cities: Jaunpur, Firozabad, Hissar)	Nasiruddin Mahmud (Timur invaded in **1398 CE** during his reign)	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	**1414–1451**	**Khizr Khan** (governor of Multan under Timur; took title *Raiyat-i-Ala*, never called himself Sultan)	Mubarak Shah (patron of Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi - *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*)	Alam Shah (abdicated voluntarily)	Delhi
Lodi (*First Afghan Dynasty*)	**1451–1526**	**Bahlul Lodi** (issued Bahloli coins)	**Sikandar Lodi** (Founded **Agra in 1504**, capital in 1506; wrote poetry as *Gulrukhi*; introduced **Gaz-i-Sikandari** 39 digits)	**Ibrahim Lodi** (Defeated & killed at First Battle of Panipat, 1526)	Delhi → Agra

Logic: Sultanate spine is **Slave 1206–1290 → Khalji 1290–1320 → Tughlaq 1320–1414 → Sayyid 1414–1451 → Lodi 1451–1526**. Do not stop at the founder year.

1A. Ghaznavid & Ghurid (before Delhi)

House	Period (from–to)	Key raids / rulers	Last / end
Ghaznavid (Mahmud of Ghazni)	Raids **1000–1027 CE** (17 expeditions in Indian tradition)	**Somnath 1025**; Al-Biruni came with him; capital Ghazni	Line continues in Afghanistan; **not** the Delhi Sultanate
Ghurid (Muhammad Ghori)	Indian career **1173–1206**	**Tarain I 1191** lost to Prithviraj; **Tarain II 1192** won; **Chandawar 1194** vs Jaichand	Murdered **1206**; slave generals (Aibak, Yalduz, Qubacha, Bakhtiyar) take the north

1B. Mughal Emperors — From / To, Last, High-Yield

Imperial high point **1526–1707**; the house on paper lasts to **1857**.

Emperor	Period (from–to)	Last / how it ended	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Babur	**1526–1530**	Died; buried **Kabul** (not Delhi)	Agra	Panipat I (**21 Apr 1526**, *Tulughma* + *Araba*); Khanwa 1527 (title *Ghazi*); Chanderi 1528; Ghaghra 1529. *Baburnama* in **Chagatai Turkish**.
Humayun	**1530–1540** and **1555–1556**	First reign ends at **Kannauj/Bilgram 1540**; restored **Sirhind 1555**; died 1556 (Sher Mandal stairs). Tomb **Delhi**	Agra / Delhi	Lost **Chausa 1539** and Kannauj 1540 to Sher Shah. Do not swap Daurah **1532** with Dharmat **1658**.
Sur (Afghan interregnum)	**1540–1555**	**Sikandar Shah Suri** beaten at Sirhind 1555	Delhi / Sasaram	**Sher Shah 1540–1545**: GT Road, rupiya, sarkar–pargana, Sasaram tomb. Islam Shah follows. **Not** a Mughal house.
Akbar	**1556–1605**	Died; buried **Sikandra (Agra)**	Agra → **Fatehpur Sikri (1571–85)** → Lahore / Agra	Panipat II **5 Nov 1556** (Bairam Khan vs Hemu). *Zabt / Dahsala 1580–81* (Todar Mal). Abolished jizya **1564**. Ibadat Khana 1575; *Sulh-i-Kul*; Din-i-Ilahi **1582**. Allahabad fort **1583**. *Ain-i-Akbari* (Abul Fazl).
Jahangir	**1605–1627**	Died; buried **Lahore** (Shahdara)	Agra / Lahore	*Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*. Hawkins **1608** (*English Khan*); **Sir Thomas Roe 1615–19**. Nur Jahan's party. Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah (Nur Jahan).
Shah Jahan	**1628–1658** (died 1666 in Agra Fort)	Deposed by Aurangzeb after Samugarh; buried **Taj / Agra**	Agra → **Shahjahanabad (Delhi)**	Taj Mahal **1631–48** (Ustad Ahmad Lahori). Red Fort & Jama Masjid. Peacock Throne. Patron of Kavindra Acharya (Banaras).
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	**1658–1707**	Died **Ahmadnagar 1707**; buried Khuldabad	Delhi / Deccan camps	Dharmat Apr 1658 → Samugarh May 1658 → Deorai 1659. Reimposed jizya **1679**. Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**. About **21 subahs**. Shivaji coronation **1674** in his reign.
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam)	**1707–1712**	Died; **not** the 1857 emperor	Delhi	Won **Jajau 1707** vs Azam. Khafi Khan: *Shahe Bekhabar*.
Bahadur Shah II Zafar	**1837–1857**	Last Mughal; **1857** Delhi; exiled **Rangoon**	Red Fort, Delhi	Son of **Akbar II**. Teachers Zauq & Ghalib. Do **not** merge with Bahadur Shah I.

> **Logic:** Mughal **founded 1526**, imperial end **1707** (Aurangzeb), legal end **1857** (Zafar). Humayun's gap **1540–1555** is **Sur**, not "Mughal continued."

1C. Regional houses — From / To (often asked as founder-only)

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler / end	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Vijayanagara	**1336–1565** as great power; Aravidu remnant to **c. 1646**	**Harihara I & Bukka I** (Sangama; Vidyaranya tradition)	**Rama Raya** killed at **Talikota 23 Jan 1565**; later Aravidu at Penukonda / Chandragiri	**Hampi** (Tungabhadra)	Order: **Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu**. Peak **Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva)** — *Amuktamalyada* (Telugu); Paes & Barbosa visited. *Nayankara / amara*. Mahanavami Dibba. Berar **absent** from the Talikota alliance.
Bahmani	**1347–1518/1527**	**Hasan Gangu = Alauddin Bahman Shah**	Splits **1518** into five Deccan Sultanates	**Gulbarga → Bidar**	**Mahmud Gawan** (prime minister; executed **1481**). Nikitin visited. Tin Darwaza = **Bidar**, not Ahmedabad.
Five Deccan Sultanates	From **c. 1518**	—	Absorbed by Mughals (Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**)	Bijapur, Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, Berar	Adil Shahi, Qutb Shahi, Nizam Shahi, Barid Shahi, Imad Shahi. Charminar = Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.
Sharqi (Jaunpur, UP)	**c. 1394–1479/1484**	**Malik Sarwar** (*Malik-us-Sharq / Khwaja-i-Jahan*)	**Hussain Shah** falls to **Bahlul Lodi**	**Jaunpur** (eastern UP)	City founded by **Firuz Tughlaq** for cousin Jauna Khan — city ≠ dynasty. **Ibrahim Shah** — *Siraj-i-Hind*; **Atala Masjid**. Vidyapati's *Kirtilata*; Jaisi's *Padmavat* in this circle. **Only this regional capital sits in modern UP.**
Maratha Swaraj / Confederacy	**1674–1818**	**Shivaji** crowned **Raigad 1674** (Gaga Bhatt)	**Peshwa Bajirao II**; Third Anglo-Maratha War **1817–18** ends Peshwaship	Raigad → later Poona (Peshwas)	Chauth 25% + Sardeshmukhi 10%. Purandar **1665** (Jai Singh I). Panipat III **1761**.

1D. Uttarakhand medieval houses (UKPCS)

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler / end	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Katyuri / Kattyuri	**c. 740–1050 CE**	**Basantandev (Basu Dev)**	Tyrant **Bir Dev / Biram Dev** overthrown; realm splits (Askot, Doti, Dwarahat, Baijnath)	**Joshimath (Kartikeyapura) → Baijnath** (Katyur valley, Bageshwar)	First historic empire of the hills. Unifier **Ishtaganadeva**. Apex **Lalitsuradeva** (Pandukeshwar plates). Bageshwar inscription of **Bhuwandev**.
Chand of Kumaon	c. 10th/11th c. legend → **1790**	**Somchand** (Jhusi/Prayag tradition) at **Champawat (Rajbunga)**	**Mahendra Chand** defeated by Gorkhas at **Hawalbagh, Jan 1790**	Champawat → **Almora (1563)** under Balo Kalyan Chand	Emblem **Garud**. **Char Aal**: Karki, Bora, Taragi, Chaudhary. Garud Gyan Chand vs Firoz Tughlaq. Baz Bahadur Chand — Taklakot / Kailash route. Tax memory: **36 Rakam 32 Kalam**.
Parmar / Panwar of Garhwal	Legend **Kanakpal 888 CE → 1804**	**Kanakpal** at **Chandpur Garhi** (Chamoli)	**Pradyumna Shah** dies vs Gorkhas at **Khudbuda / Khurbura (Dehradun), 14 May 1804**	Chandpur → Dewalgarh (1512) → **Srinagar (1517)**	**Ajay Pal** unites **52 garhs**. Rani **Karnavati** (*Nakkati Rani*, 1635). Fateh Shah grants four villages to **Guru Ram Rai** (1676). Painter **Mola Ram**.

2. Central Administrative Departments (Diwan-i-...)

Department Name	Portfolio / Nature of Office	Creator / Reformer Sultan	Key Official in Charge
Diwan-i-Wizarat	**Finance & Revenue Department** (Prime Minister)	Existed throughout; reorganized by Balban	**Wazir**
Diwan-i-Arz	**Military Department** (recruitment, inspection, muster rolls)	Created by **Ghiyasuddin Balban**	**Ariz-i-Mamalik** (Sultan remained supreme commander)
Diwan-i-Insha	**Royal Correspondence & State Chancery**	Early Sultanate	**Dabir-i-Khas**
Diwan-i-Risalat	**Religious Matters, Charities, Endowments & Foreign Appeals**	Early Sultanate	**Sadr-us-Sudur**
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Department for **Extracting Arrears from Revenue Officers**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	Mustakhraj officers
Diwan-i-Riyasat	**Market Control & Commerce Regulatory Department**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	**Naib-i-Riyasat** (controlled Shahna-i-Mandi)
Diwan-i-Kohi	**Agriculture Development Department** (crop loans/Sondhar, experimental farms)	Created by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	Amir-i-Kohi
Diwan-i-Khairat	**Charity & Public Welfare** (aid for poor, widows, orphan marriages)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Royal almoners
Diwan-i-Bandagan	**Department of Royal Slaves** (~1,80,000 slaves trained in crafts)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Khwajasara
Diwan-i-Ishtiaq	**Pension Department** for retired and destitute officials	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	-
Diwan-i-Qaza	**Judicial Department** (Civil & Criminal justice)	Established early	**Qazi-ul-Quzat**
Barid-i-Mamalik	**Intelligence & Royal Postal Spies**	Reorganized by Balban & Alauddin	Barids (reporters)
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights/Measures**	Alauddin / Firoz / Aurangzeb	Muhtasib
Dar-ul-Shafa	**Free Royal Charitable Hospital**	Built by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Hakims

2B. Delhi Sultanate Territorial & Local Administrative Hierarchy

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Iqta / Wilayat (Province) ⟶ Shiq (District) ⟶ Pargana (Sub-district) ⟶ Deh / Gram (Village)
[Head: Muqti / Wali]          [Head: Shiqdar]     [Head: Amil / Mushrif]     [Head: Muqaddam / Khut]
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Administrative Unit	Heading Officer / Functionary	Nature of Authority / Duties
Iqta / Wilayat (Province)	**Muqti / Wali / Naib Sultan**	Maintained law & order, commanded provincial troops, collected revenue, remitted surplus (*Fawazil*) to Centre
Shiq (District)	**Shiqdar**	Head of executive and military administration of the district
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Amil / Mushrif**	Assessed and collected agricultural revenue from villages
Pargana Accounts	**Karkun / Nawisinda**	Scribe and accountant maintaining land registers in Persian and Hindi
Pargana Treasury	**Fotadar / Khazandar**	Custodian of the local treasury and cash receipts
Deh / Gram (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Village headman; collected land revenue from peasants

Administrative Unit	Heading Officer / Functionary	Nature of Authority / Duties
Village Landed Elite	**Khut**	Rich peasant / hereditary village landlord (Alauddin stripped their privileges)
Village Official	**Patwari**	Maintained village land survey and revenue assessment registers
Village Group Leader	**Chaudhari**	100-village leader acting as intermediary between state and villages

3. Medieval Indian Architecture & Monuments Chronology

Monument / Structure	Location	Builder / Sultan / Emperor	Architectural Landmark / Exam Highlight
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1193 CE)	**First mosque built in Delhi**; constructed using materials from 27 demolished temples
Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra	Ajmer (Rajasthan)	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1199 CE)	Built on the ruins of a Sanskrit college (*Saraswati Kanthabharana* built by Vigraharaja IV)
Qutb Minar	Mehrauli, Delhi	Started by Aibak; **completed by Iltutmish**; repaired by Firoz Tughlaq	Dedicated to Sufi saint Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki; 72.5 m red sandstone
Tomb of Balban	Mehrauli, Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Balban** (c. 1287)	**First true architectural arch (*True Arch*)** constructed in India
Alai Darwaza	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji** (1311 CE)	**First true horseshoe arch and true dome in India**; exquisite red sandstone & white marble
Siri Fort & Hauz Khas	Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji**	Siri Fort built to protect Delhi against Mongol raids
Tughlaqabad Fort	Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**	Sloping battered walls (*batter*) and stone masonry
Kotla Firoz Shah	Delhi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Ashokan pillar brought from Topra (Haryana) and installed atop 3-tiered pyramid
Atala Masjid	**Jaunpur (Uttar Pradesh)**	**Ibrahim Shah Sharqi** (1408 CE)	Sharqi style; sloping pylons, massive central propylon gate, no minarets
Tomb of Sikandar Lodi	Lodi Gardens, Delhi	Ibrahim Lodi (1517 CE)	**First double dome in India**; octagonal plan set within a walled garden
Sasaram Tomb	Sasaram (Bihar)	**Sher Shah Suri** (architect Aliwal Khan)	Octagonal red sandstone tomb situated in the middle of an artificial square lake
Purana Qila & Qila-i-Kuhna	Delhi	**Sher Shah Suri**	Qila-i-Kuhna mosque represents transition to refined Mughal architectural aesthetic
Humayun's Tomb	Delhi	Begum Bega / Haji Begum (architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas, 1565)	**First grand garden-tomb in India (*Charbagh*)**; precursor and model for the Taj Mahal; white marble double dome; UNESCO WHS
Agra Fort	Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1565–1573)	Massive red sandstone ramparts on the Yamuna; Jahangiri Mahal
Fatehpur Sikri Complex	Near Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1571–1585)	City of victory: **Buland Darwaza** (1601, commemorating conquest of Gujarat; 54 m high), **Panch Mahal** (5-tier Buddhist-inspired pyramid), **Ibadat Khana** (1575), Tomb of Sheikh Salim Chishti (white marble lattice *Jali*)

Monument / Structure	Location	Builder / Sultan / Emperor	Architectural Landmark / Exam Highlight
Akbar's Tomb	Sikandra, Agra (UP)	Begun by Akbar; **completed by Jahangir** (1613)	Unique tier without a central dome; minarets at four corners
Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah	Agra (UP)	**Empress Nur Jahan** (1628)	Tomb of her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg; **first building made entirely of white marble** with extensive **Pietra Dura** (floral inlay with semi-precious stones); called **"Baby Taj"**
Taj Mahal	Agra (UP)	**Shah Jahan** (1631–1648)	Masterpiece of Indo-Islamic architecture; chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**; calligrapher Amanat Khan; UNESCO WHS
Red Fort & Jama Masjid	Delhi	**Shah Jahan** (1638–1648)	Shifted capital from Agra to **Shahjahanabad**; Diwan-i-Aam, Diwan-i-Khas ("*If there is a paradise on earth, it is this...*"), Peacock Throne (*Takht-i-Taus*)
Bibi Ka Maqbara	Aurangabad (Maharashtra)	**Aurangzeb / Prince Azam Shah** (1678)	Tomb of Dilras Banu Begum (Rabia-ud-Daurani); known as **"Dakhani Taj"** or poor man's replica of Taj
Moti Masjid (Red Fort Delhi)	Delhi	**Aurangzeb** (1659)	White marble private mosque within the Red Fort
Badshahi Mosque	Lahore (Pakistan)	**Aurangzeb** (1673)	Largest mosque of the Mughal Empire

4. Medieval Literature & Chroniclers (The Complete Exam Sheet)

Book / Work Title	Author	Language / Patron Ruler	Key Subject / Historical Value
Kitab-ul-Hind* / *Tahqiq-i-Hind	**Al-Biruni**	Arabic / Mahmud of Ghazni	Encyclopedic study of Indian religion, science, astronomy, and society
Chachnama	Translated by Ali Kufi	Persian (original Arabic)	History of the Arab conquest of Sindh by Muhammad bin Qasim (712 CE)
Taj-ul-Maasir	**Hasan Nizami**	Persian / Qutbuddin Aibak	First official chronicle of the Delhi Sultanate
Tabakat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj**	Persian / Nasiruddin Mahmud	Detailed political history from Muhammad Ghori to the Slave Dynasty
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi & ***Fatwa-i-Jahandari***	**Ziauddin Barani**	Persian / Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Eyewitness account of Alauddin's market reforms and Muhammad bin Tughlaq's schemes
Futuhat-i-Firoz Shahi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography detailing his public works, charities, and orthodox reforms
Tughlaq Nama, Khazain-ul-Futuh, Qiran-us-Sadain, Nuh Sipihr, Ashiqa	**Amir Khusrau** (*Tuti-i-Hind*)	Persian / Sultanate (Balban to Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq)	*Khazain-ul-Futuh* records Alauddin's conquests; *Nuh Sipihr* praises India's climate, flora, and culture; invented **Sitar**, **Qawwali**, and **Khayal** singing
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	**Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**	Persian / Mubarak Shah Sayyid	Only contemporary source for the Sayyid Dynasty
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	**Babur**	**Chagatai Turkish**	Candid royal memoirs; mentions 5 Muslim rulers (Delhi, Gujarat, Bahmani, Malwa, Bengal) and 2 Hindu kings (Krishnadeva Raya & Rana Sanga); translated into Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan

Book / Work Title	Author	Language / Patron Ruler	Key Subject / Historical Value
Humayun-nama	**Gulbadan Begum** (Babur's daughter)	Persian / Akbar	Intimate royal domestic account of the lives of Babur and Humayun
Akbarnama* & *Ain-i-Akbari	**Abul Fazl**	Persian / Akbar	Official history in 3 volumes: Vol 1 (Ancestry), Vol 2 (Akbar's reign), Vol 3 (*Ain-i-Akbari* - administrative gazetteer, revenue statistics)
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	**Abdul Qadir Badauni**	Persian / Akbar	Critical counter-narrative of Akbar's religious policies; translated Ramayana and Mahabharata (*Razmnama*) into Persian
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	**Jahangir** (completed by Mutamid Khan)	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography; reveals his passion for painting, birds, flowers, and natural history
Padshahnama	**Abdul Hamid Lahori**	Persian / Shah Jahan	Official illustrated chronicle of the first two decades of Shah Jahan's reign
Shah Jahan-nama	**Inayat Khan**	Persian / Shah Jahan	History of Shah Jahan's reign
Sirr-i-Akbar* & *Majma-ul-Bahrain	**Dara Shikoh**	Persian	*Sirr-i-Akbar* is the Persian translation of **50 Upanishads**; *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*The Mingling of Two Oceans*) harmonized Sufi and Vedantic philosophy
Alamgirnama	**Mirza Muhammad Kazim**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Official history of the first 10 years of Aurangzeb's reign (stopped by Emperor)
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	**Khafi Khan**	Persian / Later Mughal	Secretly written history of Aurangzeb's reign and Deccan campaigns
Nuskha-i-Dilkusha	**Bhimsen Saxena**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Eyewitness account of Aurangzeb's Deccan wars written from a non-courtier perspective
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadeva Raya**	**Telugu**	Masterpiece on statecraft and devotion of Andal (Godadevi) to Lord Vishnu

5. Medieval Administration, Taxes & Agrarian Revenue Systems

A. Delhi Sultanate Taxes & Core Economic Terms

- **Jizya**: Religious protection tax levied on non-Muslim subjects (*Zimmis*):
- First levied in India by **Muhammad bin Qasim** in Sindh (712 CE).
- First levied on **Brahmins** as a separate category by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**.
- **Abolished by Akbar in 1564 CE** (also abolished pilgrim tax in 1563).
- **Reimposed by Aurangzeb in 1679 CE**.
- Finally abolished permanently by later Mughal Emperor **Muhammad Shah "Rangeela"** in 1720 on recommendation of Sawai Jai Singh.
- **Zakat**: Religious property tax levied exclusively on well-to-do Muslims (at 2.5% on wealth/savings) dedicated to charity.
- **Kharaj**: General land revenue tax levied on agricultural produce of lands cultivated by non-Muslims (varying between ⅕th to ½).
- **Khams**: State's share of **spoils of war / war booty**:
- Islamic Sharia rule: ⅕th to the State Treasury, ⅘th distributed among soldiers.
- **Alauddin Khalji and Muhammad bin Tughlaq reversed this rule**: took **⅘th for the State** and gave only ⅕th to the soldiers! Firoz Tughlaq restored orthodox rule.

- **Haqq-i-Sharb**: **Irrigation tax** (levied at **10% of gross produce**) introduced by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** on peasants using state-constructed canals.
- **Chari & Ghari**: Taxes introduced by **Alauddin Khalji** — *Chari* was grazing tax on milch cattle; *Ghari* was tax on residential houses.
- **Iqta System**: Reorganized and formalized by **Iltutmish**; assignment of land revenue of a territorial tract to nobles/commanders (*Iqtadars / Muqtis / Walis*) in lieu of cash salary, responsible for maintaining troop quotas and remitting surplus (*Fawazil*) to the central treasury.
- **Fawazil**: Excess balance of revenue remitted to the imperial central treasury by an Iqtadar/Muqti after meeting local administrative and military expenses.
- **Sondhar / Taccavi**: Emergency agricultural loans given by state to farmers during famine or distress (pioneered by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** under Diwan-i-Kohi).
- **Karkhanas**: Royal manufacturing workshops; categorized into *Rikabi* (movable/travel) and *Ratibi* (fixed allowances); Firoz Shah Tughlaq maintained 36 giant royal Karkhanas.

B. Mughal Administrative Hierarchy & Key Officers

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Subah (Province) ──────► Sarkar (District) ──────► Pargana (Sub-district) ──► Deh / Gram (Village)
[Subahdar & Diwan]       [Faujdar & Amil]          [Shiqdar & Amin]           [Muqaddam & Patwari]
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1. Central Administration Officers

Official Designation	Administrative Portfolio / Key Authority	Core Exam Triggers
Wazir / Diwan-i-Ala	**Prime Minister & Head of Revenue / Finance**	Controlled revenue assessment, imperial treasury, expenditure, and provincial Diwans
Mir Bakhshi	**Head of Military Department & Intelligence**	Maintained muster rolls, inspected troops and horses (*Dagh*), issued pay certificates (**Sarkhat**) to Mansabdars
Mir Saman / Khan-i-Saman	**Head of Imperial Household & Karkhanas**	In charge of royal court provisions, imperial stores, internal palace management, state workshops
Sadr-us-Sudur	**Chief Minister of Religious Affairs & Charities**	Administered tax-free land grants (*Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal*), religious endowments, and Islamic law
Qazi-ul-Quzat	**Chief Justice of the Empire**	Highest judicial officer below Emperor; usually held simultaneously by Sadr-us-Sudur
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights**	Checked gambling, wine consumption, maintained correct weights/measures, verified Islamic practices
Mir Atish / Darogha-i-Topkhana	**Chief of Imperial Artillery**	Controlled manufacture, storage, and deployment of cannon topkhana; guarded imperial palace
Mir Barr	**Superintendent of Forests and River Navigation**	Maintained imperial boats, timber extraction, royal river flotilla
Waqia-Nawis / Sawani-Nigar	**Imperial News-Reporters & Intelligence Scribes**	Sent confidential intelligence reports from provinces directly to Emperor through Mir Bakhshi

2. Provincial, District & Local Officers

Unit	Officer Designation	Function & Authority
Subah (Province)	**Subahdar / Sipahsalar**	Governor of the Subah; commanded provincial army, maintained law and order
	Provincial Diwan	Independent financial head; reported directly to Central Wazir (kept check on Subahdar)

Unit	Officer Designation	Function & Authority
	Provincial Bakhshi	Maintained muster rolls of provincial mansabdars; acted as chief postal scout (*Waqia-Navis*)
	Kotwal	Police chief of the provincial capital; head of city surveillance, night patrol, and crime
Sarkar (District)	**Faujdar**	Executive and military head of Sarkar; suppressed rebellions, assisted Amil in revenue recovery
	Amil / Amal-Guzar	**Chief Revenue Collector & Assessor** of the district; assisted peasants, assessed crops
	Bitikchi	Chief scribe and accountant of Sarkar; prepared land and revenue assessment records
	Khazandar	District treasurer receiving collections from Parganas
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Shiqdar**	Executive and police officer of Pargana; maintained peace and assisted revenue collection
	Amil / Amin	Revenue assessor and collector at Pargana level
	Fotadar	Treasurer of Pargana
	Qanungo	Hereditary keeper of agrarian revenue records, land measurements, and local customs
Gram / Deh (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Hereditary village headman; collected land revenue from peasants (received 2.5% commission)
	Patwari	Village accountant; maintained village revenue registers (*Bahi*)

C. Mughal Land Classification (Cultivation Frequency)

Categorized in the Ain-i-Akbari based on continuous cultivation:

Land Category	Frequency of Cultivation	Quality / Revenue Status
Polaj (पोलज)	Cultivated **annually and continuously** for each harvest; never allowed to lie fallow	Best quality, most fertile agricultural land; assessed at full revenue
Parauti (परौती)	Left **fallow for 1 or 2 years** to recover soil fertility naturally	Second grade; paid full Polaj rate when brought back under the plough
Chachar (चाचर)	Left **uncultivated / fallow for 3 or 4 years**	Third grade; assessed at lower progressive tax rate to encourage reclamation
Banjar (बंजर)	Uncultivated and barren for **5 or more years**	Lowest grade; charged minimal nominal cess to promote cultivation

D. Mughal Revenue Assessment Methods

System Name	Also Known As	Key Architect / Monarch	Working Mechanism / Key Exam Facts
Zabt / Ain-i-Dahsala	**Todar Mal's Bandobast**	**Raja Todar Mal** under **Akbar (1580 / 24th regnal year)**	Average produce and average market prices of the preceding **10 years (1570–1580)** calculated; state share fixed at **⅓rd (33.3%)** payable in cash. Measured land using **Tanab** (bamboo sticks connected by iron rings replacing hemp ropes) and standardized **Gaz-i-Ilahi** (41 anguls/digits = ~33 inches). Applied across core provinces (North India & Gujarat).
Ghalla-Bakhshi / Batai	Crop-sharing / Bhaoli	Traditional system across India	Physical division of the harvested crop between state and peasant: 1. *Khet-batai*: Division of standing crop in the field before harvest. 2. *Lank-batai*: Division of harvested grain tied in sheaves before thrashing. 3. *Raas-batai*: Division of cleaned grain heap on thrashing floor (most accurate).

System Name	Also Known As	Key Architect / Monarch	Working Mechanism / Key Exam Facts
Kankut	Danabandi	Traditional appraisal system	Rough estimation and appraisal of standing crop by inspection and pacing the field (*Kan* = grain/estimation, *Kut* = conjecture).
Nasaq	Contractual assessment	Ancient method	Rough lump-sum calculation based on past revenue payments without new annual measurement.

E. Mughal Land Tenure & Jagir Categories

Land Tenure Category	Nature of Ownership / Revenue Rights	Transferability / Legal Condition
Khalisa (खालिसा)	Direct imperial crown land	Revenue deposited directly into the Central Imperial Treasury (*Bait-ul-Mal*)
Tankha Jagir (तनख्वाह जागीर)	Standard revenue assignment in lieu of cash salary	**Strictly transferable** every 3–4 years to prevent local roots/feudal power
Watan Jagir (वतन जागीर)	Homeland territories of autonomous Rajput rulers	**Hereditary and non-transferable**; continued within the royal family
Mashrut Jagir (मशरुत जागीर)	Conditional jagir assigned for a specific post/duty	Subject to temporary fulfillment of specific military/administrative duties
Altamgha Jagir (अल-तमगा जागीर)	Imperial grant initiated by **Jahangir**	**Perpetual, hereditary, irrevocable grant** confirmed with royal vermillion seal
Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal	Charitable land grant for scholars, saints, and religious divines	**Tax-free (*Inam*)** and hereditary; managed by the *Sadr-us-Sudur*
Paibaqi (पायबाकी)	Reserve land tract	Surplus revenue land kept reserved for assignment to upcoming mansabdars

F. Mansabdari System Essentials (Akbar to Aurangzeb)

- **Introduced by Akbar (1571 CE)**: Military-administrative ranking system borrowed from the Mongol decimal system; ranged from rank of 10 to 5,000 (later 7,000 for top royal princes/nobles like Raja Man Singh).
- **Dual Ranks (Zat & Sawar)**:
- **Zat (जात)**: Denoted personal rank, social status, precedence at court, and fixed the personal baseline salary.
- **Sawar (सवार)**: Denoted the actual number of cavalry troops and horses the officer was required to maintain for imperial service.
- **Three Classes of Mansabdars**:
- *Class 1*: Sawar rank = Zat rank.
- *Class 2*: Sawar rank = Half or more of Zat rank.
- *Class 3*: Sawar rank = Less than half of Zat rank.
- **Dah-Bishi Rule (10-20 Rule)**: For every 10 cavalrymen (*Sawars*), the Mansabdar had to maintain **20 horses** (to avoid exhaustion of war mounts during campaigns).
- **Dagh and Chehra**: Instituted by Alauddin Khalji, revived by Sher Shah, and formalized by Akbar:
- *Dagh*: Royal branding of war horses to prevent fraudulent substitution.
- *Chehra / Tashiha*: Descriptive roll / biometric identity of every soldier.
- **Du-aspa Sih-aspa (दो-अस्पा सिह-अस्पा)**: Introduced by **Jahangir**; allowed favored nobles to double their maintained cavalry force and salary allocation **without increasing their base Zat rank**.
- **Month-Scale System (*Mahana*)**: Introduced by **Shah Jahan**; due to divergence between estimated revenue (*Jama*) and actual realization (*Hasil*), Mansabdars were paid on 4-month, 6-month, or 8-month pay scales instead of full 12-month pay.

G. Vijayanagara & South Indian Administrative Systems

- **Nayankara System**:
- Distinctive military-tenurial system of Vijayanagara.
- King was the ultimate owner of all land; granted territories called **Amaram** to military commanders called **Nayakas / Amara-nayakas**.
- Nayakas maintained a fixed quota of foot-soldiers, horses, and elephants for the King and paid an annual tribute into the imperial treasury.
- Documented in detail by Portuguese travelers **Domingo Paes** and **Fernao Nuniz**.
- **Ayagar System**:
- Unique village autonomous administrative organization in South India.
- Every village was an autonomous unit managed by a council of **12 hereditary functionaries** called **Ayagars** (Headman/Gaud, Accountant/Karnam, Blacksmith, Carpenter, Washerman, Barber, etc.).
- Ayagars were granted hereditary tax-free plots of land called **Manyam** and received customary grain shares from the villagers.
- **Key Vijayanagara Administrative Terms**:
- **Athavana (अठवण)**: Central land revenue department.
- **Kandachara (कंदाचार)**: Military department presided over by the *Dandanayaka* (Commander-in-Chief).
- **Sist**: Standard land tax (fixed at ⅙th of gross agricultural yield based on land classification under Krishnadeva Raya).
- **Kavali**: Police duty; fees collected for village policing called *Kaval-katnam*.

6. The Medieval Battle Master Matrix (Chronological Ladder)

Year	Battle Name	Contenders	Victorious Party	Historical Impact / Prelims Takeaway
1191	**First Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan**	Ghori wounded, fled to Ghazni
1192	**Second Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Muhammad Ghori**	Laid the foundation of Muslim rule in North India
1194	**Battle of Chandawar**	Muhammad Ghori vs Jaichand (Gahadavala King of Kannauj)	**Muhammad Ghori**	Kannauj & Banaras annexed; Chandawar near Firozabad (UP)
1526 (21 Apr)	**First Battle of Panipat**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur**	First effective use of **Tulughma** tactic & artillery (*Topkhana*) in North India; Mughal Empire founded
1527 (16 Mar)	**Battle of Khanwa**	Babur vs Rana Sanga of Mewar	**Babur**	Babur declared it **Jihad**; assumed title of **Ghazi**; secured Mughal foothold
1528	**Battle of Chanderi**	Babur vs Medini Rai (Malwa chief)	**Babur**	Rajput women committed Jauhar; Babur captured Malwa forts
1529	**Battle of Ghaghra**	Babur vs Combined Afghan forces under Mahmud Lodi	**Babur**	First battle fought simultaneously on **land and river (water)**
1539 (26 Jun)	**Battle of Chausa**	Sher Khan (Sher Shah) vs Humayun	**Sher Khan**	Near Buxar (Bihar); Humayun saved by water carrier Nizam; Sher Khan took title **Sher Shah**
1540 (17 May)	**Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)**	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	**Sher Shah Suri**	Humayun driven into 15-year exile in Persia; **Second Afghan Empire (Sur Empire)** established

Year	Battle Name	Contenders	Victorious Party	Historical Impact / Prelims Takeaway
1555	**Battle of Sirhind**	Humayun (led by Bairam Khan) vs Sikandar Shah Suri	**Humayun**	Restored Mughal dynasty in Delhi; Humayun died next year falling down stairs of Sher Mandal library
1556 (5 Nov)	**Second Battle of Panipat**	Akbar (regent Bairam Khan) vs Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)	**Akbar / Bairam Khan**	Hemu struck in eye by stray arrow; captured and beheaded; ended Sur Afghan resistance
1565 (23 Jan)	**Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi / Bannihatti)**	Vijayanagara (Aliya Rama Raya) vs Combined Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar; **Berar absent!**)	**Deccan Sultanates**	Vijayanagara sacked and destroyed; shifted capital to Penukonda & Chandragiri (Aravidu dynasty)
1576 (18 Jun)	**Battle of Haldighati**	Mughal Army (Raja Man Singh of Amber & Asaf Khan) vs Maharana Pratap of Mewar	**Mughal Army** (indecisive strategic outcome)	Chetak (Pratap's horse) became legendary; Pratap continued guerrilla struggle from Kumbhalgarh/Chavand
1658 (15 Apr)	**Battle of Dharmat**	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Imperial Army (Jaswant Singh of Marwar & Qasim Khan)	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ujjain (MP); opened road to Agra
1658 (29 May)	**Battle of Samugarh**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Agra; decisive victory; Aurangzeb imprisoned Shah Jahan in Agra Fort
1659 (Apr)	**Battle of Deorai**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ajmer; Dara captured, humiliated, executed
1761 (14 Jan)	**Third Battle of Panipat**	Marathas (Sadashivrao Bhau & Vishwasrao) vs Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani) & Shuja-ud-Daula (Awadh) & Najib-ud-Daula	**Ahmad Shah Abdali**	Annihilated Maratha leadership; cleared way for British dominance

7. Foreign Travellers & Visiting Rulers (Match the Following Goldmine)

Foreign Traveler	Country of Origin	Period / Century	Indian Ruler / Court Visited	Famous Book / Key Observation
Al-Biruni (Abu Raihan)	Khwarizm (Uzbekistan)	11th c. (1017 CE)	Came with **Mahmud of Ghazni**	***Tahqiq-i-Hind* / *Kitab-ul-Hind***; deep study of Sanskrit, Hindu astronomy, philosophy, and caste system
Ibn Battuta	Tangier (Morocco)	14th c. (1333 CE)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	***Rihla***; served as Qazi of Delhi for 8 years; sent as royal ambassador to China in 1342
Marco Polo	Venice (Italy)	13th c. (1292–94 CE)	**Pandya Kingdom** (Kayal port, King Maravarman Kulasekhara) & **Kakatiya** (Queen Rudramadevi)	*Travels of Marco Polo*; noted flourishing pearl fisheries and horse imports
Nicolo Conti	Venice (Italy)	15th c. (1420 CE)	**Deva Raya I** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	Described Vijayanagara fortifications, festivals of Navaratri and Deepavali
Abdur Razzaq	Herat (Persia)	15th c. (1443 CE)	**Deva Raya II** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	*Matla-us-Sadain*; observed: "*The city is such that eyes has not seen nor ear heard of any place resembling it upon the whole earth*"
Athanasius Nikitin	Tver (Russia)	15th c. (1470–74 CE)	**Bahmani Kingdom** (under Prime Minister Mahmud Gawan & Sultan Muhammad Shah III)	*The Journey Beyond Three Seas*; noted deep contrast between extreme luxury of nobles and wretched poverty of peasants

Foreign Traveler	Country of Origin	Period / Century	Indian Ruler / Court Visited	Famous Book / Key Observation
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	16th c. (1518 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Detailed accounts of Vijayanagara trade, currency, customs, and Sati practice
Domingo Paes	Portugal	16th c. (1520–22 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara)	Described Krishnadeva Raya as *"a monarch who is gentle and wise, full of justice and equity"*; praised Mahanavami Dibba
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal	16th c. (1535–37 CE)	**Achyuta Deva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Horse trader; wrote detailed chronicle on founding of Vijayanagara and women's roles in royal court
Captain William Hawkins	England	1608–1611 CE	**Jahangir**	Reached Surat on *Hector*; spoke Turkish; Jahangir gave him title **"English Khan"** and 400 Mansab
Sir Thomas Roe	England	1615–1619 CE	**Jahangir**	Ambassador of King James I; secured imperial Farman for East India Company factories
Francisco Pelsaert	Netherlands (Dutch)	1620–1627 CE	**Jahangir**	***Remonstrantie***; detailed poverty of artisans and corruption of Mughal governors in Agra
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	France	1640–1667 CE (6 voyages)	**Shah Jahan** & **Aurangzeb**	Professional gem merchant; famous for examining and describing the **Koh-i-Noor** diamond and Peacock Throne
Francois Bernier	France	1656–1668 CE	**Aurangzeb** (Physician to Dara Shikoh)	***Travels in the Mogul Empire***; argued absence of private property in land was cause of India's decline
Niccolao Manucci	Venice (Italy)	1653–1708 CE	**Dara Shikoh** & **Aurangzeb**	***Storia do Mogor***; served as artilleryman for Dara Shikoh; later practiced medicine in Lahore and Madras

8. Bhakti & Sufi Saints & Philosophies (Core Match Matrix)

A. Philosophers & Doctrines

Philosopher Saint	Period / Century	Philosophy / Doctrine	Core Tenet	Mathas / Center
Adi Shankaracharya	8th c. (788–820 CE)	**Advaita** (*Monism / Pure Non-dualism*)	*Brahma Satyam Jagan Mithya* (Brahman alone is real, world is illusion/Maya); Atman is identical to Brahman	Established 4 cardinal Mathas: **Joshimath (Badrikashram, North - Uttarakhand)**, Sringeri (South), Dwarka (West), Puri (East)
Ramanujacharya	11th–12th c. (1017–1137 CE)	**Vishishtadvaita** (*Qualified Non-dualism*)	Atman and world are real attributes (modes) of Brahman (Vishnu); Bhakti is path to Moksha	Srirangam (Tamil Nadu); Sri Vaishnavism
Madhvacharya	13th c. (1199–1278 CE)	**Dvaita** (*Dualism*)	Strict separation between God (Brahman) and individual Soul (Jiva); 5 eternal differences	Udupi (Karnataka); Brahma Sampradaya
Nimbarkacharya	13th c.	**Dvaitadvaita** (*Dualistic Non-dualism / Bhedabheda*)	God, soul, and world are both distinct and non-distinct; Radha-Krishna devotion	Sanaka Sampradaya (Vrindavan)

Philosopher Saint	Period / Century	Philosophy / Doctrine	Core Tenet	Mathas / Center
Vallabhacharya	15th–16th c. (1479–1531 CE)	**Shuddhadvaita** (*Pure Non-dualism*)	World is not an illusion but pure manifestation of Krishna; **Pushti Marga** (Grace of God)	Rudra Sampradaya (Varanasi / Braj)
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	16th c. (1486–1534 CE)	**Achintya Bhedabheda** (*Inconceivable Oneness & Difference*)	Kirtana & Sankirtana movement; ecstatic love for Radha-Krishna	Nadia / Navadvip (Bengal)

A2. North Indian Bhakti saints — Birth and death (do not leave as "15th c." only)

North chain: **Namdev → Ramananda → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu**.

Saint	Birth–death	Place / language	High-yield
Namdev	**c. 1270–1350**	Maharashtra; verses also in Adi Granth	Varkari; Vithoba of Pandharpur
Ramananda	14th–15th c.	Banaras (UP)	Guru of Kabir and Ravidas; Rama-bhakti in the north
Kabir	15th c. (often **1398–1518** in coaching lists)	Born **Kashi / Varanasi**; died **Maghar** (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP)	Nirguna; *Bijak* (Ramaini, Sabda, Sakhi); weaver-saint. **Maghar ≠ Mathura**.
Guru Nanak	**1469–1539**	Talwandi (Nankana Sahib); died Kartarpur	First Sikh Guru; Nirguna; companion **Mardana**
Ravidas	15th–16th c.	Banaras (UP)	Ramananda circle; Dalit saint; verses in Adi Granth
Surdas	**c. 1478–1581**	**Braj** (Mathura–Vrindavan, UP)	Saguna Krishna; *Sursagar*; disciple of **Vallabhacharya**
Tulsidas	**1532–1623**	**Awadhi** belt (Rajapur / Banaras, UP)	*Ramcharitmanas* (Awadhi); Saguna Rama. Do not swap with Surdas.
Mirabai	**c. 1498–1546**	Rajasthan (Mewar) → later Dwarka tradition	Krishna devotee; **not** Andal (Tamil Alvar)
Dadu Dayal	**1544–1603**	Rajasthan	Nirguna; Dadu Panth

> **Logic:** Tulsidas = **Awadhi Rama**. Surdas = **Braj Krishna**. Kabir died at **Maghar**, not Kashi. Nanak **1469–1539**, not a 12th-century Alvar.

B. Sufi Silsilahs (Orders) in India

Silsilah	Prominent Saints	Key Center / Khanqah	Key Feature / Attitude to State
Chishti (Most popular)	**Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer - *Gharib Nawaz*), Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Ajodhan - verses in Guru Granth Sahib), **Nizamuddin Auliya** (*Mehboob-i-Ilahi* - saw reigns of 7 Sultans), Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Delhi	Ajmer, Delhi, Punjab	Kept strict distance from royal court; practiced **Sama** (musical recitals) and poverty; vegetarianism
Suhrawardi	**Sheikh Bahauddin Zakariya** (Multan), Hamiduddin Nagori	Multan, Sindh, Bengal	Accepted royal patronage, land grants (*Inam*), and state offices; wealthy lifestyles

Silsilah	Prominent Saints	Key Center / Khanqah	Key Feature / Attitude to State
Qadiri	Sheikh Abdul Qadir Jilani, Shah Niamatullah, Miyan Mir (laid foundation stone of Golden Temple), **Dara Shikoh** & Jahanara	Punjab, Sindh, Agra	Moderate; Dara Shikoh authored *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*Mingling of Two Oceans*) and translated Upanishads into Persian (*Sirr-i-Akbar*)
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah, **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (*Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani*)	Delhi, Sirhind	Orthodox and puritanical; strictly opposed *Sama*, opposed Akbar's liberal policies; propounded *Wahdat-ul-Shuhud*

9. Marathas & Shivaji's Administration

A. Shivaji's Ashtapradhan Council (Direct Matching Questions)

Member	Designation / Portfolio	Primary Function
1. Peshwa	**Mukhya Pradhan** (Prime Minister)	Overall general administration; represented king in his absence
2. Amatya / Mazumdar	**Finance Minister** / Auditor	Audited all public and military accounts
3. Sachiv / Shurnavis	**Home / Royal Secretary**	Royal correspondence, checked official edicts and sanity of royal accounts
4. Mantri / Waqia-Navis	**Interior Minister / Chronicler**	Recorded daily proceedings of court, intelligence & espionage
5. Senapati / Sari-i-Naubat	**Commander-in-Chief**	Recruitment, military organization, and field operations
6. Sumant / Dabir	**Foreign Minister**	Managed diplomatic relations, embassies, and foreign visitors
7. Nyayadhish	**Chief Justice**	Civil and criminal justice administration
8. Panditrao / Danadhyaksha	**High Priest / Minister for Charities**	Religious affairs, endowments, grants, and penances

> **Note:** All members except **Nyayadhish** and **Panditrao** were required to lead military commands in times of war.

B. Core Maratha Terms

- **Chauth**: Levy of **one-fourth (25%)** of land revenue extracted from neighbouring territories to protect them from Maratha raids.
- **Sardeshmukhi**: Additional **10% levy** claimed by Shivaji in his capacity as hereditary supreme head (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra.
- **Mirasdars**: Hereditary landholders.
- **Bargirs**: Regular cavalry provided with horses and weapons by the state.
- **Silahdars**: Mercenary cavalrymen who brought their own horses and arms.
- **Treaty of Purandar (1665)**: Between Shivaji and Mughal General **Raja Jai Singh I** of Amber; Shivaji surrendered 23 out of 35 forts.
- **Coronation (1674)**: At **Raigad Fort** by pandit **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi; assumed titles **Chhatrapati** and *Haindava Dharmoddharak*.